

Minutes ~~2.13.2023~~: Monday, April 5, 2021 at 930AM



Called to Order:

- 6:30pm in the Walkerton Elementary cafeteria

Attendees:

- President: Claire Kellems
- Secretary: Emily Winchell
- Principal: Dr. Fuller
- Heather Jackson
- Ashley Filley
- Erin Hesters

Past Minutes:

- Minutes from January were sent via email to board members and were accepted as submitted. Minutes are uploaded to the website.

Treasurers Report:

- Report was submitted by Jamie Alexander, Claire presented. Also included with these minutes.
- General Fund \$18,626.46
- Book Vending Machine: \$2,261.90

Principals Report: Dr Fuller wanted to congratulate the Science Bowl for coming in 3rd at State competition.

Old Business:

- **Hacienda Night:** We had an amazing turn out! Total amount earned from this fundraising event was \$2,655.34.
- **Science Fair:** Science Fair was this week, with only a few projects submitted. The PTA would like to extend out thanks to Maria Knowlton for all of her work in organizing this event for the students of WES. We brainstormed some ideas in getting more students and staff involved.
- **Volunteer Opportunities/ Committee Chairs:** We discussed upcoming events that may need volunteers and passed around a signup sheet for parents.

New Business:

- **Penny/Coin Wars and Movie Field Trip:** We are hosting a Penny War between grade levels from March 6-10; the winning grade will win a field trip to the Plymouth movie theatre on March 16th! Start saving all of your coins! Thank you to Mr. Walter for helping us decorate the buckets for each grade level.
- **Bingo Night:** March 10 from 6-7pm, come join us! Thank you to Erin Hesters for helping with this event. We will serve popcorn and water and will have a prize for everyone who attends. Other game prizes will be purchased on Amazon.
- **STEAM Museum:** An amazing museum coming to the school on April 13 and 14. We are in need of 6/8 volunteers each day. A signup sheet was available. Dr. Fuller will include in the school wide newsletter.
- **Fun Fair:** mark your calendars April 28th 5-8pm for a great night of fun! We discussed game ideas: cake walk, karaoke, photo booth, game truck, food trucks. We discussed reaching out to the JG Art Club to inquire about face painting. Ashley Filley offered to reach out to a contact she knows for inflatables, we are working with Heather to add the insurance rider for this portion of the fun fair. Heather also offered to reach out to Ms. Haluda to inquire about a silent auction for the vent, Heather Jackson offered to reach out to a local BBQ food truck contact to invite them to our event. Heather also offered to reach out to Dawn Miller to inquire about their ice cream truck joining us.
- **Nomination Committee:** Heather Jackson, Ashley Filley and Erin Hesters were so gracious to step up to serve as our Nominating Committee.
- **Teacher Appreciation Week:** May 8-12th we will celebrate the amazing staff at WES. The PTA would like to host a lunch in for all staff on Friday of that week, with other small celebrations all week long. We will include in Dr. Fuller's weekly newsletter how students can also participate. Dr. Fuller also threw out the idea of having a Massage Therapist come in to offer massages in the teacher lounge. Claire made a motion to budget \$500.00 for the week of festivities, Emily 2nd.

Open Floor:

We discussed ways to connect with more parents and to recruit more volunteers. We tossed around the idea of sending out a questionnaire to parents asking them a few questions like:

1. What can the PTA do to help you be more involved?

2. What is the ideal monthly meeting time/day?

3. What event(s) would you like to volunteer for?

Next Meeting:

- **Monday, March 13, 2022, at 6:30 pm**

Adjournment:

- 6:05 pm, Motion to adjourn by Dr. Fuller and Emily Winchell 2nd

Treasurer's Report

1/1/2023 – 1/31/2023

General Account

Opening Balance 1/1/22: \$15971.12

• Expenses NONE

• Receipts

○ Hacienda Fundraiser 2655.34

Ending Balance 1/31/23: \$ 18626.46

-\$100 JG Theater Booster

-\$130 KNO refunds (stale dated-not reflected in balance)

Secondary Account (Book Vending Machine Budget)

Opening Balance 1/1/23: 2261.90

• Expenses NONE

• Income NONE

Ending Balance 1/31/23: \$2261.90

~~Present: Commission members Bruce Lorentzen, Richard Wolf, Francine Goldstein, Alison McElhone, Terry Castellano, Don Gumaer, Mary Francois ; SWCAA liaison and Senior Center Director Wendy Petty; Weston Social Services Director Allison Lisbon~~

~~Note: This meeting was held via Google Meet Video Call due to Coronavirus pandemic~~

~~The meeting convened at 9:34 AM.~~

~~The minutes of the last meeting (March 2021) were approved.~~

~~Wendy gave the COVID vaccine update. Second dose clinic (and single dose Johnson and Johnson) will be later this month. The center probably won't host anymore vaccine clinics. EMS together with the Health Department traveled to give the J and J vaccine to homebound elderly in Weston.~~

~~Wendy discussed the Senior Center reopening plans. All of the Fairfield senior centers have been meeting monthly via zoom. All are planning a reopening in June. Wendy anticipates hosting 1-2 classes at a time, and continuing to offer zoom programs. There will likely be a waiver and a vaccination requirement. Bruce said the idea of vaccination passport is going through the courts now. Wendy said Roy has been asking all persons he drives if they've been vaccinated. So far everyone is.~~

~~Richard gave the facilities update. There is 20,000 in the capital budget for the Senior Center. Wendy is preparing a list of cosmetic items if funding is, indeed, approved by the Board of Finance. Specifically, she is looking into new carpet and~~

tiling in certain areas. Bruce asked Richard if there has been any information on the Economic Vitality Committee after Lance Scott resigned? Mary did not think the Committee had gone defunct.

Regarding the budget process, Allison reported the Board of Finance had asked the schools and town if there was anything that could be cut from the budget. Wendy and Allison were also asked (as were all Town Departments) by the Selectman to speak about what their departments were specifically doing. This was apparently after concerns were raised on social media about no one being at Town Hall.

Bruce commented that in a recent review by the Town, this commission was functioning well, with the exception of providing meeting minutes in a timely fashion. He asked if I would submit the meeting minutes to him within several days of each meeting.

Allison gave the Social Services update. The Department has been helping seniors with applications for the Weston Warm Up Fund. Person's can apply for reimbursement of fuel cost. Applications are due May 1. This year Allison anticipates less money will be requested from the Warm Up Fund as the state program was helping. Primarily people that did not qualify for the state program will apply for Warm up assistance. This year, seniors can still apply for the tax abatement and deferment programs, which have not changed. These applications are due May 15. Richard asked if people currently on the tax programs notified about application deadlines. They are. Allison said the Social Services Department also sends reminders to all eligible seniors, and it is announced in the Senior Center newsletter. The Social Services Department continue to help with the food pantry and food deliveries. Don asked about prepared meals, now that Peters Market is closed. Allison said the prepared meals slowed during COVID pandemic. The Jewish Center in Fairfield delivers prepared meals monthly.

Wendy gave the Senior Center update. Everyone on the Commission, with the exception of Mary, are getting the weekly bulletin, which highlights the Center happenings. In addition to Senior Center plans discussed earlier, the center does plan weekly curbside lunches again, for 10-12 weeks.

As for Dial a ride, Roy has been getting busier and wants to be able to drive 2 people at a time to cut down on travel. He continues to deliver meals one day per week.

There was no Friends of the Weston Senior Center update, as Diana was not present.

The meeting adjourned at 10:22AM

Respectfully submitted,

Alison McElhone